PRACTICE 01 · 10-MINUTE

The Overwhelm *Practice*

Overwhelm → **Grounded**

DURATION	WHEN	LEVEL	STEPS
10 minutes	*Any time*	*Beginner*	*4*

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Overwhelm is the feeling of having too much happening at once. Too many thoughts, tasks, or emotions asking for attention at the same time. It pulls you forward into what needs to be done, what might go wrong, what can't be dropped.

Nothing is wrong with you. Your system is responding to carrying a lot. This practice is here to help you come back into the present and create a little space again.

> ***"I am safe in this moment."***

A note before you begin.

This practiceonly workswhen you actually do it, not when you read about it. The shift happens in your body, not in your head. Trust what you feel during it, even if it surprises you.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- A quiet place to sit
- Something to write with
- Something to track time
- 10 uninterrupted minutes

Optional: Lavender, bergamot, or frankincense essential oil. Choose one and inhale gently before you start. It signals to the nervous system that something is about to shift.

PRACTICE OVERVIEW

> This practice works in sequence. First naming what's happening in your mind, then moving it through your body, then returning you to the present. Each step builds on the last. Don't skip ahead.

1	Thought Work	*2 min*
2	EFT Tapping	*6 min*
3	Gratitude	*1 min*
4	Close	*1 min*

THE PRACTICE

01 Thought Work

7 MINUTES

Between what's happening around you and how you're responding to it, there's a gap. That gap is where this whole practice lives. Most of the time, we skip right over it. Our brain generates a thought, the thought triggers a feeling, the feeling drives a behaviour, and suddenly it's a habit we didn't choose.

With overwhelm specifically, that gap has been flooded. Your brain has been running on autopilot in 'doing mode'. Before you can look at any thought clearly, you need to shift into 'being mode' for a few minutes. The breath is how we do that.

1. BREATHE IN

Take three slow, deliberate breaths. Inhale for 4 counts. Exhale for 6.

This is not relaxation, it's a shift in mode. The longer exhale tells your brain you're not in danger right now.

2. FIND IT IN YOUR BODY

Without trying to fix anything yet, ask yourself: Where in my body am I feeling overwhelmed right now?

Scan gently. Maybe it's tightness in the chest, a buzzing through your limbs, shallow breathing, or tension behind your eyes. Notice it without labelling it as good or bad.

3. WRITE YOUR THOUGHTS

Set a timer for 60-90 seconds. Write down every thought your brain is generating right now. Don't edit or organise, just let it come out.

4. FIND A THOUGHT YOU CAN BELIEVE

Look at your list. Find the thought carrying the most charge.

We're not forcing a positive replacement. We're loosening the grip just enough to allow something slightly more spacious in.

Try these on and see what fits:

"I have a lot to do. I can choose what comes first."

"I don't have to solve everything today."

"One thing at a time is enough."

"I've been here before, and I've found my way through."

02 EFT Tapping

6 MINUTES

EFT (Emotional Freedom Techniques) involves tapping specific acupressure points on the face and body while staying present with the feeling you identified in step one. Research shows it reduces cortisol measurably. The mechanism is direct: tapping these points sends calming signals to the amygdala, interrupting the stress response at its source.

Brad Yates · EFT Tapping for Overwhelm YouTube · ~6 minutes youtu.be/cmB264VOw80

Hold the thought or feeling you identified in step one while you tap. Stay present until it ends. If the charge softens, notice it.

03 Gratitude

1 MINUTE

Thisisn'taboutpretending the overwhelm wasn't real. It's about shifting your nervous system from a threat orientationtoward the present. Genuine gratitude, not forced, changes what your brain is scanning for. Your body follows.

1. WRITE 3 THINGS YOU ARE GENUINELY GRATEFUL FOR

They don't need to be significant. Once written, take one breath. Let the sensation settle in your body, not just your head.

04 Close

1 MINUTE

Setthetoneforwhat comes next. Place one hand on your heart. Choose one statement that feels steady and believablerightnow. Not aspirational, just true.

"I'm allowed to take this one step at a time."

"I don't need to carry everything at once."

"I support myself today."

PRACTICE COMPLETE

Overwhelm often comes from living too far ahead.

Today,you choseto come backto yourself.Youdon'tneedtoholdeverythingatonce.Returntothispractice whenever the weight starts building again.

Creating inner balance, one small pause at a time.

CONTINUE THE WORK

The Full Library. All five Practices for $57.

Overwhelm isone layer.Pressure,self-doubt,uncertainty,andguilt are the others. The Full Library gives you a structured practice for each one.

stan.store/innerbalance101 →